

Φαβίος Πίκτωρ ὁ ἱστορικός

Fabius Pictor's Roman History in Greek

eul_aid: ksw

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)

Domain: Ἱστορία [History](#)

Format: Πεζός [Prose](#)

Quintus Fabius Pictor was a Roman senator and the earliest known Roman historian. A member of the patrician Fabian family, he served during the Second Punic War. Following the Roman defeat at the Battle of Cannae in 216 BCE, he was part of a delegation sent to consult the Oracle at Delphi.

He composed a history of Rome in Greek prose, titled **Historiai** or **Praxeis**. The work, now lost and surviving only in fragments, covered events from Rome's origins through the Second Punic War. It is considered the first prose history of Rome written by a Roman.

Fabius Pictor holds a foundational position in Roman historiography. His decision to write in Greek aimed to justify Roman actions to a Hellenistic audience, adapting Greek historiographical models for Roman self-presentation. He established an annalistic structure followed by later historians and served as a key, though often biased, source for authors such as Polybius.

Works (1)

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